

Experiment with the effects of the variation of parameters on graphs of related functions, using digital tools, making connections between graphical and algebraic representations, and generalising emerging patterns

Learning intention

- experiment with the effects of the variation of parameters on graphs of related functions, using digital tools, making connections between graphical and algebraic representations, and generalising emerging patterns.

Teach and model

- experimenting with digital tools by applying transformations to the graphs of functions, such as reciprocal $y = \frac{1}{x}$, square root $y = \sqrt{x}$.
- investigating transformations of the graph of $y = x$ to the graph of $y = ax + b$ by systematic variation of a and b and interpreting the effects of these transformations using digital tools.
- investigating transformations of the parabola $y = x^2$ in the Cartesian plane using digital tools to determine the relationship between graphical and algebraic representations of quadratic functions.

Check understanding

- Explain the main idea and give one accurate example.
- Show the idea in a second way: with words, a model, a diagram or symbols.
- Apply the idea to a short unfamiliar situation and justify the result.

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Teaching cautions

- Ask the student to explain their choice, not only state an answer.
- Check that key vocabulary is understood in a new example.
- Mix representations so the skill is transferred rather than copied.

Quick lesson sequence

- Connect to prior knowledge and introduce the key vocabulary.
- Model one clear example, then solve a second example together.
- Finish with an independent check and a short student explanation.